

To me, the most interesting person in the exhibit area was Rita Jenrette, the ex-wife of ex-Congressman John Jenrette. The two of them once admitted making love on the Capitol steps, after which he'd been sent to jail in the ABSCAM case while she appeared nude in *Playboy*. To find her sitting in the booth for Bridgewater Securities was a pleasant surprise. She looked a little chubbier than I remembered from the photos, but attractive enough so that the Bridgewater Securities booth never lacked for an audience. While Ms. Jenrette signed copies of her recently published novel, her co-workers explained the advantages of a well-managed portfolio of foreign bonds.

To the side of the booth was a cardboard raffle box, where you could put in a coupon to win a free dinner with Ms. Jenrette. After depositing several chances to show my good will, I introduced myself to her and asked how she came to be interested in foreign bonds. She told me she'd passed her Series 7 exam to become a licensed stockbroker after a friend suggested that career one day after church. She said being a stockbroker was preferable to being married, especially to Mr. Jenrette, who, she said, still had a girlfriend living near Fort Lauderdale. "I'd never ask for alimony," she confided. "That would only give John another chance to manipulate me. It's much better to have financial independence."

A few hours after we'd had our conversation, an emissary from Bridgewater ran up to tell me I'd won the dinner. I was thrilled until I found out that almost everyone who'd put in a coupon had won the dinner, and that Bridgewater had reserved a special dining room to accommodate a large party of men. They'd also planned some special entertainment, which, I think, was a slide show about deutsche mark-denominated debt instruments.

I decided against sharing Ms. Jenrette's company with so many fellow investors and went back to ask her if I could get her views on foreign bonds on a one-to-one basis. She said she worked out of Bridgewater's New York office, and I could call her there.

For four straight afternoons, I attended meetings with hundreds of other conferees. The majority seemed to be retired. We wandered from lecture to lecture, picking up advice on Australian interest rates, the importance of the M-3 money supply relative to industrial production, topping actions, and the advance/decline